

Year-End Connect Employee Guide

Welcome to Your Year-End Connect

Year-End Connect is a key part of our annual performance and development cycle. It offers you the opportunity to reflect on the goals you set throughout the year, highlight your achievements, and share the impact you've made.

This is your space to tell the story of your year on what you delivered, how you lived our Aristocrat Values, and where you want to grow next. Your insights will help shape your performance conversation with your manager and ensure your contributions are recognized as we wrap up the current goals cycle and prepare for what's ahead.

Year-End Connect is completed in Workday, where you'll be guided through a short, structured reflection covering your contributions, development focus, and a self-assessment of your overall performance and values.

Year-End Connect Timeline

17 August (US)

Year-End Connect launches for all eligible employees. Ensure your goals have been entered and updated in Workday.

28 August (US)

Employee deadline to complete Year-End Connect.

31 August (US)

Managers can begin completing the Year-End Connect for their employees.

18 September (US)

Manager's deadline to complete and submit the Year-End Connect for their employees in Workday.

19 – 30 October (US)

Managers can begin having Year-End Connect performance conversations with employees.

Additional Resources:

Connect Page:

☐ [Talent Practices & Enablement – Year-End Connect](#)

Goal Setting resources:

☐ [Ally SharePoint – FY25 Goal Setting](#)

Values resource:

☐ [Aristocrat Values](#)



Year-End Connect

Workday Form Overview

Year-End Connect Form

The **Year-End Connect** form will be available for all eligible employees in Workday. This Connect will be divided into three sections: **Performance Review Questions, Aristocrat Values, and Overall Performance Rating.**

Once you submit your form in Workday, it will automatically advance to your manager's Workday Inbox to complete your performance review.

Performance Review Questions

This section will allow you to reflect on your performance, highlight your achievements and challenges from the year, and share your plans for development in the upcoming year.

Question #1:

Reflecting on your goals this year, what were your 2-3 contributions, and what impact did they create? Were there any goals you did not achieve this year? If so, what obstacles did you face that may have impacted your progress?



Helpful Tips for Completing This Question:

- ☐ Be results-oriented – Focus on the outcomes of your work and how they support team or business goals.
- ☐ Use data or examples – When possible, include measurable results, stakeholder feedback, or real examples to bring your contributions to life.
- ☐ Connect to your goals – Reference the goals you set at the beginning of the year and how you progressed against them.



Question #1: Example Response

- This year, I delivered two major product enhancements that addressed long-standing customer pain points. I led the redesign of the user interface for our core platform, resulting in a 35% reduction in support tickets related to navigation. I also introduced a new automated reporting tool that cut internal processing time by nearly 50 hours per month.
- Additionally, I played a key role in stabilizing our Q2 release following a challenging deployment. I facilitated the root cause analysis and coordinated with Engineering and QA to implement new protocols that prevented future regressions.
- One area where I fell short was meeting the target deadline for our API documentation revamp. The project required more external dependency coordination than anticipated, but I've reprioritized and plan to relaunch this in the next cycle.

Year-End Connect

Workday Form Overview



Performance Review Questions

Question #2:

For the upcoming year, what skills or areas do you want to develop, and what support or resources will help you succeed?

This question is your chance to think ahead and be intentional about your development. Consider both your current role and your long-term aspirations.



Helpful Tips to Guide Your Response:

- ☐ Reflect on feedback – Consider input you've received from your manager, peers, or stakeholders.
- ☐ Tie development to business goals – Think about how developing this skill will help your team or the organization.
- ☐ Consider different types of growth – This could include technical skills, leadership capabilities, communication, or strategic thinking.
- ☐ Identify support – Mention what kind of support would be helpful (e.g., coaching, stretch projects, mentoring, courses, etc.).



Question #1: Example Response

- In the upcoming year, I'd like to strengthen my skills in technical documentation and cross-functional collaboration, particularly as I revisit the API documentation revamp project. One challenge I encountered was managing multiple external dependencies and aligning expectations across teams. To improve, I'd benefit from formal training or mentorship in agile documentation practices and stakeholder alignment strategies.
- I also want to continue developing my product storytelling and communication skills, especially when presenting complex technical updates to non-technical stakeholders.
- To support these goals, I'd welcome support in the following areas
 - Access to internal or external courses on technical writing and stakeholder communication.
 - Opportunities to present at cross-functional forums or team showcases.
 - Feedback and coaching after product demos or documentation reviews.

Year-End Connect

Workday Form Overview

Aristocrat Values

In this section of your Year-End Connect, you'll be asked to reflect on **how you brought our Aristocrat Values to life over the past year** and select an overall rating that best represents your demonstration of those values. Review our Aristocrat Values and Role Model Behaviors below:

All About The Player



We bring joy to life through the power of play.

- ✓ Brings customers and players into every conversation and every decision.
- ✓ Anticipates the future needs of customers by providing innovative solutions.
- ✓ Always strives to deliver new benefits and deeper relationships with customers and an outstanding experience for players.

Talent Unleashed



Innovation, creativity, and capability are the heart and soul of everything we do, and we're committed to nurturing the talents of all our people, no matter what they are or what role they play in our diverse team.

- ✓ Takes ownership of personal development and is open to new opportunities.
- ✓ Works proactively and takes initiative to challenge the status quo.
- ✓ Speaks up, asks the brave questions, and resolves problems quickly.

Collective Brilliance



Individually, we're great, but together, we can be brilliant.

- ✓ Demonstrates ability to create value through collaboration.
- ✓ Finds innovation and improvement opportunities in all that we do.
- ✓ Builds strong relationships across groups, while supporting and encouraging others.

Good Business, Good Citizen



We're a big company, with big responsibilities.

- ✓ Takes responsibility for doing the right thing.
- ✓ Meets the highest standards of rigor and governance internally.
- ✓ Role models ethical behavior in every discussion and decision.

Year-End Connect

Workday Form Overview

Aristocrat Values

Upon reviewing our values, you'll be asked to assess yourself using the following rating scale. See below for examples to guide you to the appropriate rating. Remember, the focus is not only on how you achieved your goals (**what you did**), but also how you role modeled our values (**how you accomplished the goals.**)

Rating	Meaning	Example Responses
Consistently Demonstrated	You regularly demonstrated Aristocrat's Values in your day-to-day work and interactions. You were a strong role model and intentionally lived out the values across a range of situations.	I consistently brought our values to life this year. I championed All About the Player by driving UX improvements that led to a 35% drop in support tickets. I demonstrated Collective Brilliance through strong collaboration during our Q2 release recovery, and Talent Unleashed by mentoring new team members and fostering innovation within the team.
Sometimes Demonstrated	You demonstrated the values in some situations, but not consistently throughout the year. There are opportunities to embed these behaviors more consistently moving forward.	I demonstrated Talent Unleashed by leading innovation sprints that improved efficiency. While I worked well independently, I recognize that I could have shown Collective Brilliance more consistently by involving other teams earlier in key projects. This will be a focus for me next year.
Seldom Demonstrated	You had limited opportunities or missed key moments to demonstrate the values. There's a clear opportunity for growth in this area.	I demonstrated Good Business, Good Citizen by upholding compliance standards and doing the right thing in challenging situations. However, I missed some opportunities to show Talent Unleashed and Collective Brilliance and will focus on being more proactive and collaborative moving forward.

Year-End Connect

Workday Form Overview

Overall Performance Rating

This section will provide you with the opportunity to select a rating (Unsatisfactory, Challenging, Successful, Strong, or Exceptional) for your self-assessment.

See below for our Performance Rating definitions:

Rating	Living Our Values	Rating Definition
Exceptional	Always goes above and beyond to role model the values within and outside their area/department.	- Exceeds expectations on all goals and achieves goals well above peers. Demonstrates exceptional technical/functional expertise. - Took on additional responsibilities or projects beyond peers and exceeded expectations on all.
Strong	Consistently goes above and beyond to role model the values across the organization.	- Exceeds expectations on most goals, beyond those achieved by peers. Demonstrates strong technical/functional expertise. - Took on additional responsibilities or projects beyond peers and exceeded expectations on most.
Successful <i>A successful rating makes you eligible for 100% of the individual component of your bonus.</i>	Consistently role models the values, not requiring correction or growth.	- Meets or exceeds expectations on all goals. Actively demonstrates technical/functional expertise. - Took on some additional projects/tasks and met expectations while maintaining successful performance overall.
Challenging	Inconsistent demonstration of values or still learning how to demonstrate them.	- Misses expectations occasionally or requires frequent direction/help to achieve goals. May need to develop technical/functional expertise. - Did not take on additional responsibilities or projects and may have struggled to learn or achieve key responsibilities.
Unsatisfactory	Rarely lives the values. Coaching and feedback have not been applied to themselves.	- Misses expectations on most or all goals. Does not have the technical/functional expertise to deliver goals. - Did not take on additional responsibilities or projects and failed to complete many responsibilities.

Year-End Connect

Workday Form Overview



Overall Performance Rating

After reviewing our performance rating scale, you'll have the opportunity to include additional comments as they relate to your overall rating. Below are example responses.

Example Rating: Successful

This year, I consistently met expectations across all performance goals and delivered high-quality work. I actively applied my technical knowledge to support key product enhancements and took ownership of my core responsibilities.

I contributed to our Q2 release planning, maintained strong collaboration within my immediate team, and supported process improvements aligned to my role. While I didn't lead large-scale initiatives, I showed steady growth and reliability across the board, consistently role modeling Aristocrat Values in my day-to-day work.

Example Rating: Strong

I exceeded expectations on the majority of my performance goals and consistently delivered outcomes above the standard for my role. I led the automation of our internal reporting process, which saved 50+ hours monthly across teams, and took the initiative to redesign a key feature based on customer feedback; both efforts directly contributed to business efficiency and player experience.

I actively mentored a junior team member and regularly collaborated with Engineering and QA to drive product improvements. Throughout the year, I demonstrated Aristocrat's Values beyond my role, particularly **Talent Unleashed** and **Collective Brilliance**, by proactively supporting initiatives outside of my immediate responsibilities.

Example Rating: Challenging

This year, I experienced challenges in consistently meeting expectations across my goals. While I made progress in a few areas, such as supporting the initial testing phase of our product release, I required frequent guidance and follow-up to stay on track. I encountered difficulties with managing timelines and adapting to shifting priorities, which impacted my ability to deliver results independently.

I recognize the need to further strengthen my technical capabilities and time management skills and have already begun working with my manager to build a clearer development plan. I remain committed to improving and contributing more effectively to the upcoming year.

Year-End Connect

Completing the Form in Workday

Below are step-by-step instructions to help you complete your Year-End Connect form in Workday.

1 You will receive an email notification in Outlook from Workday regarding your Year-End Connect being available. You may either click directly on the link or log in to Workday to start your Connect form.

2 Access the form in your **Workday Inbox** and click **'Get Started.'**

Employee Evaluation

Welcome to your FY26 Year-End Connect!

The Year-End Connect is our formal annual review, giving you the opportunity to reflect on your achievements over the past year, assess how you progressed on your goals, and share insights into your growth and experiences.

Throughout the year, we've offered opportunities like Jump Start Connect and Mid-Year Connect to help you set goals, reflect on progress, and make any needed adjustments. The Year-End Connect brings it all together and looks at the bigger picture of how your contributions supported your team and the business.

This Connect is also a chance to think ahead. Your reflections will help shape meaningful conversations with your manager and lay the groundwork for next year's goals and development.

Please take a few moments to complete your Year-End Connect by **28 August (US)**. Once submitted, it will automatically be routed to your manager to be completed.

TIP: This should take approximately 30 minutes to complete. Keep your responses focused and concise—using bullet points can help summarize key points for your conversation.

Get Started

3 Use bullet points to summarize your insights and to complete the following sections:

✓ Performance Review

- ✓ Respond to two prompt questions reflecting on your key contributions and development areas for the coming year.

✓ Aristocrat Values

- ✓ Review each Aristocrat value and reflect on how you demonstrated them over the past year, then provide an overall rating.

✓ Overall Performance Rating

- ✓ Add a summary comment on your overall performance for the year and select a final rating.

✓ Review and Submit

- ✓ Check for any final updates and submit your review. Once submitted, it will be sent to your manager.

Complete Self Evaluation

Self Evaluation: FY26 Year-End Connect:

Actions

10/01/2025 - 09/30/2026

 [View Talent Data](#)

☒ Performance Review

☐ Aristocrat Values

☐ Overall Performance Rating

☐ Review and Submit

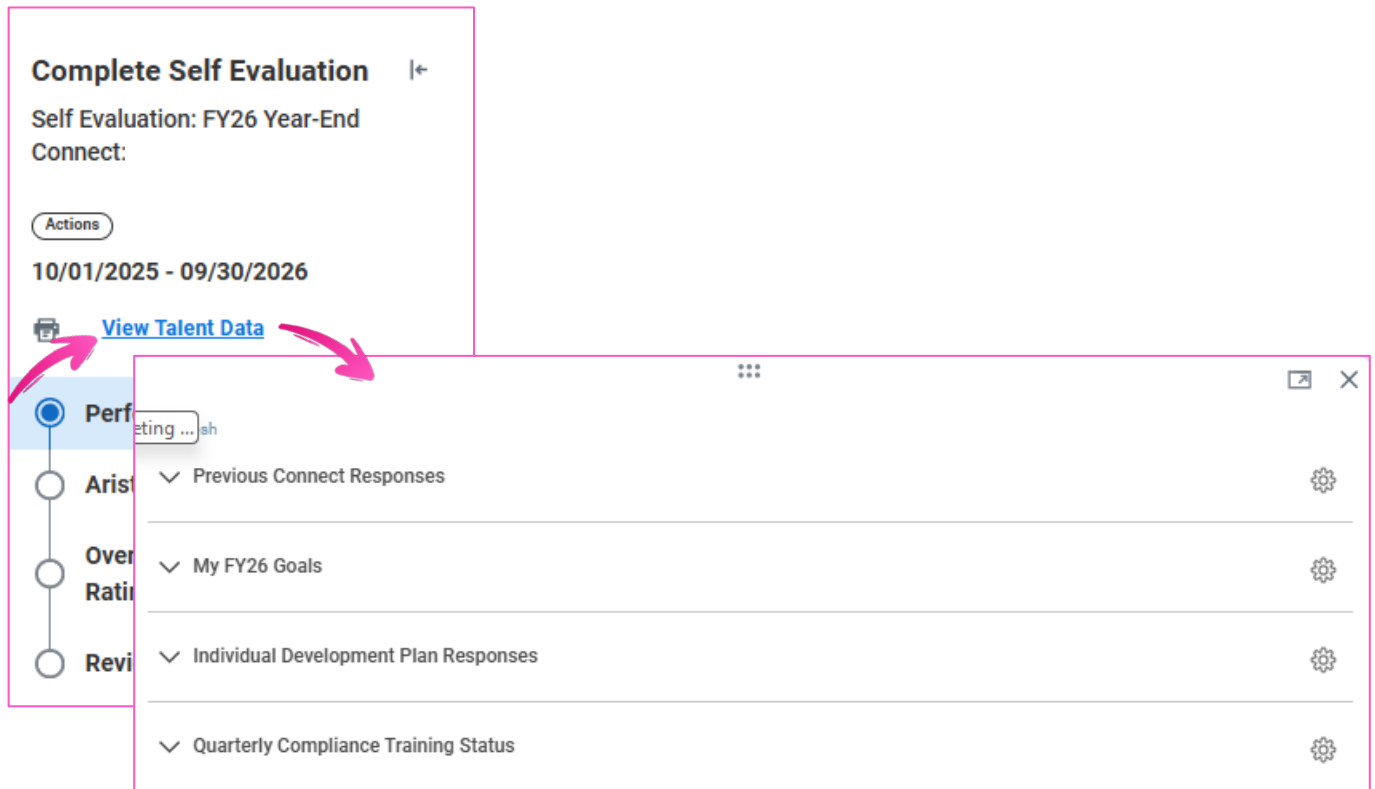
For illustrative purposes

Year-End Connect

Completing the Form in Workday

Tips in the Connect Form:

- ❑ **Access Your Talent Data:** Click the '**View Talent Data**' link (next to the printer icon) to view your past Connect responses, goals, development plans, and compliance training completion.
- ❑ **Leverage Your Data:** Reference this information to highlight key accomplishments. Align your responses to your goals and development focus areas. Use past insights to create a well-rounded, accurate review.



- 4 Review your form, make any updates as necessary, and click '**Submit.**' This will move your Year-End Connect form to your manager. If you need to make any updates to your Connect, please ask your manager to '**Send it Back**' to your Workday inbox.



Year-End Connect

Employee FAQs



Q

When does the Performance Review period for Fiscal Year 2026 (FY26) start and end?

A

The FY26 Performance Review period is from 1 October 2025 to 30 September 2026.

Q

What criteria am I being evaluated on during the performance review period?

A

At Aristocrat, we believe in measuring performance based on two factors:

- Performance as related to achieving company and individual goals
- Behaviors related to bringing our company values to life

Q

What is the process and timeline for completing the performance review process?

A

You can find the timeline and deadline dates on our [Connects page](#) in Ally.

Q

What if I do not have goals entered into Workday?

A

Log into Workday and input your goals for the year before the Year End Connect launches. Please also ensure you update the status of your goals so your manager can view your progress when completing your review. For detailed instructions, visit the Goal Setting Resources & Tools page. For detailed instructions, visit the [Goal Setting Resources & Tools page](#).

Q

I'm a newly hired employee. Should I complete a review?

A

Employees hired on or after 1 July (US) will not receive a Year-End Connect form. However, they will discuss performance with their manager during the first 90 days.

Year-End Connect

Employee FAQs



Q

Who is eligible for the Year-End Connect?

A

Employees who have been with the company since 1 July (US) will receive a Year-End Connect form.

Contingent Workers and Contractors are excluded.

Q

I am not eligible for a bonus. Why should I go through the performance process?

A

The Year-End Connect is intended to summarize performance discussions throughout the year. These two-way discussions are a platform for you and your manager to share feedback and summarize progress.

Q

How do I know the performance review process is fair? What if I disagree with the feedback or rating I received?

A

Aristocrat has a structured approach with various levels of review to ensure fairness and consistency across all individuals. If you have concerns related to a fair performance review process, speak with your P&C Business Partner.

Q

I am eligible to participate in the Year-End Connect, but I am new to my role. Should I complete the performance review process?

A

The performance review period evaluates individual performance from October – September. You should evaluate your performance based on the work you completed during this period. You do not need to complete the Year-End Connect if you were hired after 1 July (US).

Q

I was recently promoted or moved into a different role. Should I evaluate my performance while in my current or new role?

A

You should evaluate yourself in the role that reflects most of the work you have completed throughout the year (October – September). However, if you have goals for both, you evaluate both. Please note that both of your managers will provide input on your Year-End Connect.

Year-End Connect

Employee FAQs



Q

I had a change in reporting manager toward the end of the performance year. Who should evaluate my review?

A

While Workday will automatically send your Year-End Connect to your current manager, if you worked with a different manager for most of the performance year, they will partner with your current manager to discuss your performance and goals before completing the review.

Q

Who can I contact if I have more questions about the Year-End Connect?

A

Please get in touch with your manager or P&C Business Partner.

Q

I missed the opportunity to complete my Year-End Connect (reasons such as PTO). Can I still complete it after the period closes?

A

You may or may not be able to complete it, depending on the timing of the process. Please get in touch with your manager or P&C Business Partner for additional guidance.

Goals FAQs

Q

Can I still input my FY26 goals in Workday before completing my Year-End Connect?

A

Yes, you can still input your goals in Workday before completing your Year-End Connect form. Once you have submitted your goals, they will automatically update in the Connect form. Visit the [Ally SharePoint – Goal Setting](#) for additional resources.

Q

As I look at my goals in Workday, I noticed a section that says “Goals That Need to Be Reviewed” what does this mean?

A

If you see a section under your Goals in Workday labeled as “Goals That Need to Be Reviewed” then it means that you have goals under that category that need to be revised. This indicates that the due date may be incorrect, or your goals are misplaced under a different category. We encourage you to review all goals to ensure that they have been entered properly.